

SOP-LV-034 — Heat & Cold Stress Prevention

Recognizing and Preventing Temperature-Related Illness in the Field

SOP NUMBER	SOP-LV-034
TITLE	Heat & Cold Stress Prevention
EFFECTIVE DATE	July 25, 2026
REVISION	1.0
APPLIES TO	All Apex field technicians — Ontario & Manitoba
CATEGORY	Environmental Hazards

1. Purpose

This procedure helps Apex technicians recognize and prevent heat- and cold-related illness during outdoor work, unconditioned attic and mechanical-room work, and Manitoba winter conditions.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to all Apex technicians whenever ambient conditions create a meaningful risk of heat or cold stress, including summer attic work and winter exterior or unheated-building work.

3. Definitions

- Heat Exhaustion — heavy sweating, weakness, dizziness, nausea, and headache from prolonged heat exposure.
- Heat Stroke — a medical emergency: confusion, hot and dry (or clammy) skin, and a very high body temperature. Life-threatening.
- Frostbite — freezing of skin and underlying tissue, starting with numbness and a white or greyish patch.
- Hypothermia — dangerously low body temperature; early signs include shivering, which stops as hypothermia worsens — a critical warning sign, not a sign of improvement.

4. Heat Stress Prevention

- Hydrate before, during, and after work in heat — don't wait until you feel thirsty.
- Take work/rest breaks in high heat, more frequently as temperature and humidity rise.
- Wear light-coloured, breathable clothing where the task allows.
- Watch yourself and your crew for early symptoms — heavy sweating, dizziness, nausea, headache.

5. Heat Emergency Response

Confusion, hot/dry skin, or a very high body temperature is heat stroke — call 911 immediately.

While waiting for help: move the person to shade or a cool area, remove excess clothing, and cool them with

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water or a fan if available. For heat exhaustion (without confusion), move to a cool area, hydrate, and rest — seek medical attention if symptoms don't improve quickly.

6. Cold Stress Prevention

- Dress in layers that can be added or removed as activity level changes.
- Take warm-up breaks in extended cold exposure.
- Watch for numbness, pale or greyish skin patches, or shivering that stops — stop work and warm up immediately if any of these appear.

7. Cold Emergency Response

- Move the person to a warm area and remove any wet clothing.
- Do not rub or massage frostbitten skin.
- Call 911 for suspected hypothermia — confusion, slurred speech, or shivering that has stopped are all emergency signs.

8. Attic and Unconditioned Space Guidance

Summer attic temperatures can exceed 60°C (140°F). Limit continuous time in these spaces, hydrate before entry, and use a check-in plan per SOP-LV-029 so someone knows your entry time and expected duration.

9. Prohibited Practices

- Never ignore early symptoms of heat or cold stress and push through — stop, cool down or warm up, and reassess.
- Never work alone in an extreme-heat attic space without a check-in plan.

10. Reporting

Any heat- or cold-related illness, even if resolved on site, is reported to your supervisor the same day and documented using the Apex Incident Report process.

11. Regulatory References

- Ontario Occupational Health and Safety Act, s. 25 — general duty
- Ontario Ministry of Labour, Immigration, Training and Skills Development — Heat Stress guidance (best-practice guideline, referenced for procedure design)
- Manitoba Workplace Safety and Health Act, C.C.S.M. c. W210 — general duty provisions

12. Related Apex Documents

- SOP-LV-029 — Lone Worker Safety
- SOP-LV-004 — Power Tools Safety

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13. Revision History

Rev.	Date	Description	Approved By
1.0	Jul 25, 2026	Initial release	P. Cimini

This document is proprietary to Apex and is intended for internal use by Apex technicians and supervisors. Effective date: July 25, 2026.